
“In giving **freedom to the slave**, we assure **freedom to the free ...**”

ABRAHAM LINCOLN, MESSAGE TO CONGRESS, DECEMBER 1, 1862

Tireless ambition was the driving force in Abraham Lincoln's journey to the White House. In the words of William H. Herndon, with whom he built a successful law practice in Springfield, Illinois, “his ambition was a little engine that knew no rest.”



The rail candidate

An 1860 cartoon shows Lincoln borne along on a fence rail, held aloft by the slavery issue and the Republican party, represented by newspaper editor Horace Greeley. Much was made of Lincoln's frontier, “rail-splitting” youth.

Rise to fame